

SĀM̐KHYA

DUALIST ARCHITECTURE → KNOWLEDGE AND PROOF OF → THREE GUṆAS → TWENTY-FIVE TATTVAS → SATKĀRYAVĀDA → WHY MANY PURUṢAS?

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g10 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

DUALIST ARCHITECTURE

DUALIST ARCHITECTURE SATKĀRYAVĀDA + TATTVA EVOLUTION + PLURAL PURUṢAS PRAKṚTI PURUṢA ONE, UNCONSCIOUS, PRODUCTIVE MANY, CONSCIOUS, INACTIVE WITNESSES SĀM̐KHYA – SATKĀRYAVĀDA + TATTVA EVOLUTION + PLURAL PURUṢAS

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SĀM̐KHYA = SATKĀRYAVĀDA + TATTVA EVOLUTION + PLURAL PURUṢAS
- PRAKṚTI PURUṢA one, unconscious, productive many, conscious, inactive witnesses aiyakta equilibrium of guṇas uncaused, unchanging, non-agent apparent association

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- discrimination ends bondage
- SĀM̐KHYA = SATKĀRYAVĀDA + TATTVA EVOLUTION + PLURAL PURUṢAS

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- PRAKṚTI PURUṢA one, unconscious, productive many, conscious inactive witnesses aiyakta equilibrium of guṇas uncaused, unchanging, non-agent apparent association
- discrimination ends bondage.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — (RECOMMENDED OPENING DEFINITION): “Sāṃkhya (the enumerative dualist school) is a realist dualism in which three pramāṇas (means of valid knowledge) establish one unconscious Prakṛti (primordial material nature) and many conscious Puruṣas (pure witnesses).”.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (RECOMMENDED OPENING DEFINITION): “Sāṃkhya (the enumerative dualist school) is a realist dualism in which three pramāṇas (means of valid knowledge) establish one unconscious Prakṛti (primordial material nature) and many conscious Puruṣas (pure witnesses).”.

01

STAGE 01

KNOWLEDGE AND PROOF OF PRAKṚTI

KNOWLEDGE AND PROOF OF PRAKṚTI THREE PRAMĀNAS RELIABLE TESTIMONY PRAKṚTI IS INFERRED, NOT ORDINARILY PERCEIVED FINITE EFFECTS SHARE COMMON FEATURES COORDINATED WORLD REQUIRES COMMON SOURCE EVOLUTES NEED AN UNEVOLVED GROUND PLEASURE/PAIN/DULLNESS IN EFFECTS SATTVA/RAJAS/TAMAS IN CAUSE BEGINNINGLESS, UNMANIFEST, INDEPENDENT MATERIAL CAUSE NOT “MATTER” ALONE, BUT PSYCHOPHYSICAL SOURCE OF INTELLECT, SENSES

THREE PRAMĀNAS: perception

reliable testimony prakṛti is inferred, not ordinarily perceived finite effects require cause → effects share

world requires common source → evolves need an unevolved ground pleasure/pain/dullness in effects → sattva/rajas/tamas

PRAKṚTI: beginningless, unmanifest, independent material cause

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- THREE PRAMĀNAS: perception
- reliable testimony prakṛti is inferred, not ordinarily perceived finite effects require cause → effects share common features coordinated

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- world requires common source → evolves need an unevolved ground pleasure/pain/dullness in effects → sattva/rajas/tamas in cause
- PRAKṚTI: beginningless, unmanifest, independent material cause

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- not “matter” alone, but psychophysical source of intellect, senses and elements.
- THREE PRAMĀNAS: perception

MECHANISM / VERDICT — (RECOMMENDED OPENING DEFINITION): “Prakṛti (primordial material nature) is the one unmanifest material root whose three guṇas (constituent qualities)—illumination, activity and restraint—explain both psychological and cosmic diversity through changing proportions.”.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (RECOMMENDED OPENING DEFINITION): “Prakṛti (primordial material nature) is the one unmanifest material root whose three guṇas (constituent qualities)—illumination, activity and restraint—explain both psychological and cosmic diversity through changing proportions.”.

02

STAGE 02

THREE GUṆAS

THREE GUṆAS SATTVA LIGHTNESS PRAKṚTI EQUILIBRIUM BREAKS RAJAS TAMAS ACTIVITY PAIN INERTIA DULLNESS GUṆAS ARE CONSTITUENTS, NOT DETACHABLE QUALITIES MUTUAL DOMINATION

SATTVA lightness

PRAKṚTI equilibrium breaks

RAJAS TAMAS activity

pain inertia

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SATTVA lightness
- PRAKṚTI equilibrium breaks

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- RAJAS TAMAS activity
- pain inertia

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- dullness guṇas are constituents, not detachable qualities mutual domination + support + production drive all manifest difference.
- SATTVA lightness

MECHANISM / VERDICT — (RECOMMENDED OPENING DEFINITION): “Puruṣa (the pure conscious witness) is inactive, non-objectifiable and distinct from every product of Prakṛti, while jiva (the empirical embodied self) is Puruṣa apparently identified with intellect, ego and the subtle body.”.

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03

STAGE 03

TWENTY-FIVE TATTVAS

TWENTY-FIVE TATTVAS PRAKṚTI (1) BUDDHI (2) AHAMKĀRA (3) MANAS (4) + 5 JĀNENDRIYAS + 5 KARMENDRIYAS 5 TANMĀTRAS 5 MAHĀBHŪTAS RĀJASA SUPPLIES ACTIVITY TO BOTH BRANCHES

PRAKṚTI (1)

MAHAT / BUDDHI (2)

AHAMKĀRA (3)

sāttvika → MANAS (4) + 5 JĀNENDRIYAS + 5 KARMENDRIYAS

tāmasa → 5 TANMĀTRAS → 5 MAHĀBHŪTAS

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- PRAKṚTI (1)
- MAHAT / BUDDHI (2)
- AHAMKĀRA (3)

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- sāttvika → MANAS (4) + 5 JĀNENDRIYAS + 5 KARMENDRIYAS
- tāmasa → 5 TANMĀTRAS → 5 MAHĀBHŪTAS
- rājasa supplies activity to both branches

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- PURUṢA (25) stands outside the evolveute chain as witness
- COUNT CONTROL: 1 prakṛti + 23 evolves + puruṣa = 25 tattvas.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — (CORE ARGUMENT): “Satkāryavāda (the theory that the effect pre-exists potentially in its cause) and parināmavāda (real transformation) make the evolution of twenty-five fundamental principles a manifestation of determinate causal powers rather than creation from non-being.”.

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04

STAGE 04

SATKĀRYAVĀDA

EFFECT PRE-EXISTS LATENTLY IN CAUSE ASADAKARANĀT NON-BEING CANNOT BE PRODUCED UPADĀNAGRAHAṆĀT SPECIFIC MATERIAL CAUSE IS SELECTED SARVASAMBHAVĀBHĀVĀT NOT EVERYTHING ARISES FROM EVERYTHING ŚAKTASYA ŚAKYAKARANĀT CAUSE PRODUCES ONLY WHAT IT HAS POWER TO PRODUCE

EFFECT SHARES NATURE OF CAUSE PARINĀMAVĀDA REAL TRANSFORMATION OF PRAKṚTI NYĀYA ĀRAMBHAVĀDA

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- EFFECT PRE-EXISTS LATENTLY IN CAUSE asadakaranāt: non-being cannot be produced upadānagrahaṇāt: specific material cause is selected sarvasambhavābhāvāt: not
- everything arises from everything śaktasya śakyakaranāt: cause produces only what it has power to produce kāranābhāvāt: effect shares

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- nature of cause parināmavāda: real transformation of prakṛti
- NYĀYA ārambhavāda: new effect

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- ADVAITA vivarta: apparent transformation.
- EFFECT PRE-EXISTS LATENTLY IN CAUSE asadakaranāt: non-being cannot be produced upadānagrahaṇāt: specific material cause is selected sarvasambhavābhāvāt: not

MECHANISM / VERDICT — (FINAL VERDICT): “The power of Sāṃkhya (the enumerative dualist school) lies in connecting epistemology, material continuity, empirical consciousness and liberation within one system; its weakness is that the relation required to connect its two absolutes remains under-explained.”.

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05

STAGE 05

WHY MANY PURUṢAS?

WHY MANY PURUṢAS? PURUṢA EXISTS BECAUSE COMPOSITES SERVE ANOTHER EXPERIENCE NEEDS CONSCIOUS WITNESS OBJECTS OF THREE GUṆAS REQUIRE LIBERATION IS CONCEIVABLE BIRTHS/DEATHS DIFFER; SENSE CAPACITIES AND ACTIONS ARE UNCOORDINATED

IF ONE PURUṢA, ONE PERSON’S LIBERATION OR PAIN WOULD CONTACT PROBLEM INACTIVE CONSCIOUSNESS CANNOT LITERALLY TOUCH UNCONSCIOUS PRAKṚTI ANALOGIES

PURUṢA EXISTS BECAUSE composites serve another

experience needs conscious witness objects of three guṇas require non-guṇa experienter

liberation is conceivable

PLURALITY: births/deaths differ; sense capacities and actions are uncoordinated

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- PURUṢA EXISTS BECAUSE composites serve another
- experience needs conscious witness objects of three guṇas require non-guṇa experienter
- liberation is conceivable

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- PLURALITY: births/deaths differ; sense capacities and actions are uncoordinated
- if one puruṣa, one person’s liberation or pain would belong to all
- CONTACT PROBLEM: inactive consciousness cannot literally touch unconscious prakṛti analogies: blind-and-lame cooperation

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- magnet and iron pressure remains: how does mere proximity begin purposive evolution?

MECHANISM / VERDICT — PURUṢA EXISTS BECAUSE composites serve another | experience needs conscious witness objects of three guṇas require non-guṇa experienter | liberation is conceivable

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (CRITICISM): “Sāṃkhya (the enumerative dualist school) integrates psychology, cosmology and liberation without a creator God, yet guṇa-explanation risks elasticity, Puruṣa-plurality lacks a clear individuator, and mere proximity does not fully solve the contact problem.”.

06

STAGE 06

BONDAGE, LIBERATION AND CRITIQUE

BONDAGE, LIBERATION AND CRITIQUE BUDDHI’S STATES ARE APPROPRIATED AS “I” BY REFLECTED CONSCIOUSNESS REPEATED EMBODIMENT TATTVA-JĪĀNA “I AM PURUṢA, NOT PRAKṚTI OR ITS EVOLUTES” PRAKṚTI CEASES ACTIVITY FOR THAT PURUṢA UNCONSCIOUS PRAKṚTI CANNOT ACT FOR AN END; DUALISM CANNOT SĀM̐KHYA REPLY TELEOLOGY IS IMMANENT, AS MILK FLOWS FOR CALF; NO

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- AVIVEKA: buddhi’s states are appropriated as “I” by reflected consciousness experience + karmic dispositions → repeated embodiment tattva-jīhāna
- / viveka-khyāti: “I am puruṣa, not prakṛti or its evolves” prakṛti has been seen → ceases activity for

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- that puruṣa → KAIVALYA
- SĀM̐KARA: unconscious prakṛti cannot act for an end; dualism cannot explain contact

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- SĀM̐KHYA REPLY: teleology is immanent, as milk flows for calf; no creator is needed.
- AVIVEKA: buddhi’s states are appropriated as “I” by reflected consciousness experience + karmic dispositions → repeated embodiment tattva-jīhāna

MECHANISM / VERDICT — (CRITICISM): “Kaivalya (liberating isolation of consciousness) follows from viveka-jīhāna (discriminative knowledge), but the system’s hardest burden is explaining how inactive consciousness and unconscious nature can sustain coordinated, purposive experience.”.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (CRITICISM): “Kaivalya (liberating isolation of consciousness) follows from viveka-jīhāna (discriminative knowledge), but the system’s hardest burden is explaining how inactive consciousness and unconscious nature can sustain coordinated, purposive experience.”.

07

STAGE 07

PYQ ANSWER SYNTHESIS

PYQ ANSWER SYNTHESIS START WITH DUALISM AND THREE GUṆAS PROVE PRAKṚTI AND PLURAL PURUṢAS DRAW EXACT 25-TATTVA CASCADE DEFEND SATKĀRYAVĀDA WITH FIVE REASONS DISTINGUISH PARINĀMA FROM ĀRAMBHA/VIVARTA EXPLAIN AVIVEKA AND KAIVALYA

TEST CONTACT AND TELEOLOGY OBJECTIONS

START with dualism and three guṇas → prove prakṛti and plural puruṣas

draw exact 25-tattva cascade → defend satkāryavāda with five reasons

distinguish parināma from ārambha/vivarta

explain aviveka and kaivalya → test contact and teleology objections

QUALIFIED VERDICT: Sāṃkhya powerfully unifies cosmos, mind and liberation, but the coordination of inactive consciousness

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- START with dualism and three guṇas → prove prakṛti and plural puruṣas
- draw exact 25-tattva cascade → defend satkāryavāda with five reasons

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- distinguish parināma from ārambha/vivarta
- explain aviveka and kaivalya → test contact and teleology objections

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- QUALIFIED VERDICT: Sāṃkhya powerfully unifies cosmos, mind and liberation, but the coordination of inactive consciousness with unconscious nature
- is its hard problem.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — QUALIFIED VERDICT: Sāṃkhya powerfully unifies cosmos, mind and liberation, but the coordination of inactive consciousness with unconscious nature is its hard problem.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Sāṃkhya powerfully unifies cosmos, mind and liberation, but the coordination of inactive consciousness with unconscious nature is its hard problem.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT LAYER-PLACEMENT NOTE LAYER-PLACEMENT NOTE ALL LAYER 3 MATERIAL FROM THE LEGACY IT SHOULD REFINE A CORE ANSWER, NOT DISPLACE THE LAYER 3 - ADVANCED ADVANCED PROOF BURDEN AND COGNITION ITS THREE ACCEPTED PRAMANAS.

THIS ECONOMY CREATES A BURDEN IMPERCEPTIBLE PRAKṚITI AND PURUṢA CANNOT SIMPLY BE ASSERTED.

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- Layer-placement note
- Layer-placement note All Layer 3 material from the legacy complete session is retained here after practice.
- It should refine a core answer, not displace the printed syllabus.
- LAYER 3 - ADVANCED Advanced proof burden and cognition model Sāṃkhya reduces comparison, postulation, non-apprehension and tradition to

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- its three accepted pramanas.
- This economy creates a burden: imperceptible Prakṛiti and Puruṣa cannot simply be asserted.
- Samanyato-dṛṣṭa inference must reach entities never presented as ordinary sense-objects.
- Carvaka attacks the unobserved universal relation, while Nyaya grants inference but proposes atoms and Isvara as a more economical explanation.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- Sāṃkhya replies that material continuity, guṇa-patterns and the objectifiability of experience jointly require one material root and a
- distinct witness.
- Empirical cognition occurs through the inner instrument.
- Manas coordinates, ahamkara appropriates and buddhi determines.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels